

Interview Preparation Guide

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This document provides a structured framework for upcoming design interviews, synthesizing your resume, portfolio case studies, and professional philosophy.

1. “Tell Me About Yourself” (2-Minute Script)

Core Theme: The bridge between traditional craft and digital systems.

“Hi, I’m Luke. I’m a graphic designer and art director with over ten years of experience across Toronto and Seoul. My background is a bit unique—I actually started in fine arts, studying ceramic art, before transitioning into graphic design at OCAD University. That foundation means I’ve always viewed design not just as pixels on a screen, but as physical, spatial, and systemic experiences.

Over the past decade, I’ve worked on everything from regulated packaging systems to digital product design. For example, at V-TAG, I led the packaging design for over 20 SKUs, turning strict Health Canada regulations into a scalable visual language. Recently, I independently designed, built, and shipped a daily operations app for kindergartens in South Korea, which is now live and managing over 120 students across multiple bus routes.

Alongside my corporate work, I founded and ran Reasonab Design Academy (RDA) for ten years, mentoring students and managing a small studio that generated consistent revenue and local design jobs. I thrive in environments where I can build systems from scratch, bridge the gap between creative vision and operational reality, and ultimately create work that solves real problems for real people. I’m currently looking for a full-time role in Toronto where I can bring this end-to-end perspective to a strong design team.”

2. Phone Interview: Expected Questions & Model Answers

Q: What are you looking for in your next role? “I’m looking for a full-time role in Toronto where I can apply my end-to-end design thinking—from initial concept to final production. Having run my own studio and worked as a lead designer, I enjoy taking ownership of projects. I want to join a collaborative team where I can contribute to building robust design systems, whether that’s in branding, packaging, or digital products.”

Q: Can you describe your design process? “My process is deeply rooted in the ADDIE model—Analysis, Design, Development, Implementation, and Evaluation. For instance, on the V-TAG project, I didn’t just start drawing. I first analyzed Health Canada’s regulations. Then I designed the typographic hierarchy and warning block systems. I developed production-ready files for our

factory in Shenzhen, implemented them through press checks, and evaluated the final retail presence. I always start with constraints and build systems that turn those constraints into a cohesive brand language.”

Q: How do you handle tight deadlines or pressure? “I rely on strong systems and clear communication. When I joined V-TAG, production was slow because the file infrastructure was messy. I rebuilt the grid systems and templates, which cut our production turnaround by roughly two-thirds. When the foundation is organized, you can move very fast without losing quality.”

3. In-Person Interview: Deep Dive Questions

Q: Tell me about a time you had to learn something completely new for a project. “The LittleN kindergarten app is a perfect example. I noticed a critical operational problem with their bus routes—paper logs were failing. I spent two months working as a bus aide to truly understand the friction points. Then, I used AI tools to augment my design workflow, translating my UX/UI designs into a functional coded app. It pushed me to learn how to direct generative AI effectively, cutting the concept-to-launch time from months to weeks.”

Q: How do you handle strict constraints or regulations in your design? “I actually prefer having constraints. At V-TAG, we had to comply with Health Canada’s vaping regulations—mandatory warning blocks, bilingual parity, specific symbol sizes. Instead of fighting it, I used those rules as the structural logic of the packaging system. The constraints dictated the grid, and that grid became the visual identity of the brand.”

Q: You ran your own academy (RDA) for 10 years. Why are you looking for a full-time corporate role now? “Running RDA was an incredible experience in entrepreneurship, mentoring, and system-building. But after a decade, especially post-COVID, I realized I had achieved what I set out to do there. I want to bring that ownership mentality and leadership experience into a larger team environment. I miss the scale and collaborative energy of working within a dedicated brand or agency.”

4. Portfolio Walkthrough Talking Points

CS01: LittleN × Sandeul (UI/UX & AI Workflow)

- **The Hook:** “Design research isn’t always done in a studio.”
- **Key Points:** Emphasize the 2-month field research as a bus aide. Discuss how you designed the system temporally (morning vs. afternoon states). Highlight the use of AI to accelerate development, resulting in a live v1.12 app with an 86% daily revisit rate.

CS02: Urban Dive Marketing (Brand Systems)

- **The Hook:** “Building a brand that works across all touchpoints.”
- **Key Points:** Discuss your role as Senior Graphic Designer. Focus on how you translated client briefs into comprehensive design strategies, managing weekly milestones and presenting quarterly metrics to executives.

CS03: AZOTO (Identity & Spatial Design)

- **The Hook:** “Building a brand from absolute zero.”
- **Key Points:** Talk about the UKIN incubator environment. Explain how you derived the AZOTO logo from the geometric shapes of an ice cream cone and translated that sharp, high-contrast aesthetic into the physical store interiors, leading to massive queues and TV coverage.

CS04: V-TAG (Packaging & Compliance)

- **The Hook:** “Turning regulatory constraints into brand architecture.”
- **Key Points:** Walk through the ADDIE process applied to packaging. Mention managing over 20 SKUs, communicating with the Shenzhen factory, and the Shenzhen Exhibition booth design that attracted 3x the expected traffic.

CS06: Reasonab Design Academy (Leadership & Mentoring)

- **The Hook:** “Design as a practice of communication and community.”
 - **Key Points:** Discuss the operational scale (~\$100K CAD annual revenue, managing teachers and international applications). Emphasize your philosophy: following official RGD guidelines while adapting teaching methods to new technology, referencing the “Good artists borrow, great artists steal” mindset.
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5. Questions to Ask the Interviewer

1. “Looking at the designers who have been most successful on your team, what traits or habits do they share?”
2. “How does your team currently handle the handoff between design and production (or development)?”

3. "What is the biggest design or operational challenge your team is focused on solving in the next six months?"
4. "I noticed [Company Name] recently launched [Project/Product]. How did the design team approach the constraints on that project?"